

Pacific Ocean

The Pacific is the biggest and deepest ocean, stretching nearly halfway around the world at its widest point. It was once even broader, but is steadily shrinking as the Atlantic gets wider. It is dotted with volcanic islands and submerged seamounts, and its ocean floor is scarred by deep trenches that include the lowest point on Earth.

FACT FILE

Area:	64,000,000 sq miles (166,000,000 sq km)
Average depth:	14,040 ft (4,280 m)
Deepest point:	35,840 ft (10,924 m)

▼ GIANT OCEAN

The Pacific is so vast that it takes two maps to show its full extent. The western side near Asia has far more islands than the eastern side, where there are more of the long cracks in the ocean floor known as fracture zones.

There are more than 20,000 islands scattered across the Pacific Ocean.

